



△ BLAZE OF RED

Sugar maples make up 20-50 percent of the trees in the northern Green Mountains and are noted for their fiery-red leaves in fall.

The Green Mountain National Forest

One of two national forests in northeastern North America, covering the Green Mountains with many colors in fall



Vermont's Green Mountain National Forest consists of more than 625 square miles (1,620 square km), spread over and around the mountains that share its name. Many of the peaks in the forest are over 2,950 ft (900 m), and the spruce, maple, beech, and paper birch that cover them make the region a popular tourist destination, particularly in fall, when the forest becomes a blaze of color. Softwood as well as hardwood tree species flourish in the region, and these, coupled with a dense understory fed by mountain streams and winter snowfall, provide food and shelter for a wide variety of bird and other animal species. Beavers, moose, deer, and wild turkeys are common, as well as gray wolves and black bears.



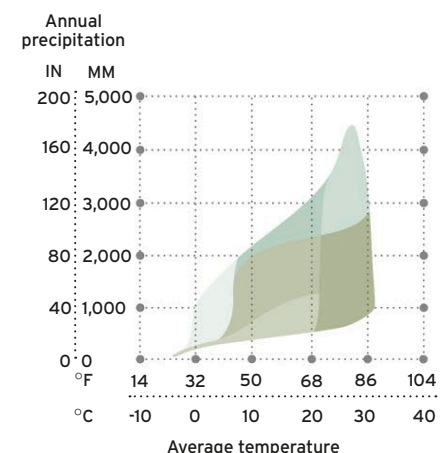
△ FALL COLORS

The wide variety of Green Mountain trees produces a multihued landscape in the fall, ranging from light gold to deep red.

The **Green Mountain Bear Corridor** serves as a vital **north-south passage** for bears

FOREST TYPES AND CLIMATE

Forest types vary with latitude. Closest to the equator are tropical forests, which include evergreen rain forests or those with two seasons—dry and wet. At higher latitudes lie temperate forests, which consist of broadleaf rain forests as well as deciduous forests with defined seasons. At latitudes of 50° to 60° North, where summers are warm and short and winters cold and long, coniferous boreal forests flourish.



KEY

- Boreal forest
- Temperate rain forest
- Temperate deciduous forest
- Tropical rain forest
- Tropical seasonal forest
- Woodland